

Shafiqullah Yousafzai

University of Tsukuba, Tsukuba City, Japan
Email: Shafiqullah1991@gmail.com | Phone: +81-80-5885-4218
ORCID: <https://orcid.org/0009-0003-8397-6702>
Website: <https://sites.google.com/view/shafiqullahyousafzai>

Career Objectives

I am passionate about pursuing an academic research career in international economics, international trade, applied microeconomics, and public policy. I aim to contribute to high-quality empirical research and impactful projects, engage in international collaborations, secure competitive research funding, and actively contribute to teaching and mentoring.

Education

Ph.D. in International Public Policy (Applied Economics), University of Tsukuba, Japan

Apr 2022 – Mar 2025

Dissertation: Economic Analysis of Exchange Rate Volatility, Labor Market Rigidity, Exports, and Regional Inequality

Committee: Hisahiro Naito (Chair), Yoshinori Kurokawa, Yu Zhengfei, Kenichi Kashiwagi

Master's in International Public Policy (Applied Economics), University of Tsukuba, Japan

Oct 2020 – Mar 2022

B.S. (Hons) in Economics and Finance, National University of Modern Languages, Pakistan

Aug 2011 – Jun 2015

Employment

Associate Professor, University of World Economy and Diplomacy (UWED), Tashkent, Uzbekistan

Starting September 2026- May 2027

Lecturer (Part-Time), Pamir Institute of Higher Education, Afghanistan

Mar 2019 – Aug 2020

- Taught undergraduate courses in Development Economics, Business Management, and Introduction to Research.

Data Entry Operator, Netlinks, Afghanistan

Dec 2016 – May 2017

Field Investigator, Society for Sustainable Development of Afghanistan, Afghanistan

Oct 2015 – Nov 2016

- Team leader in WASH, CLTS and ODF projects sponsored by UNICEF.

Research

Papers Submitted for Peer Review:

1. Trade Hubs and the Uneven Gains from Globalization: Urban and Rural Disparities from Satellite Nighttime Lights Data (with Hisahiro Naito)
2. The Effect of Exchange Rate Volatility and Labor Market Rigidity on Export Growth (with Hisahiro Naito)

Working Papers:

1. The Interaction Effect of Unpredictable Exchange Rate Shocks and Labor Market Rigidity on Export Growth: An Analysis Based on Country–Industry Data (with Hisahiro Naito)
2. Differential Farming Systems, Farm Productivity, and Resource Use Efficiency: The Case of Wheat Production in Afghanistan (with Mohammad Abdul Malek and Kenichi Kashiwagi)

Work in Progress:

1. The Effects of Exports on Infant Mortality: A Panel Data Analysis of Sub-Saharan African Countries (with Hisahiro Naito)
2. Can DMSP Night Light Capture Household-Level Welfare? Evidence from a Cluster-Level Quasi-Panel of the Demographic and Health Survey (with Hisahiro Naito)

Technical & Research Skills

Research Skills: Applied econometric analysis (cross-sectional, panel data, causal inference), Quantitative policy evaluation, Academic writing and publication preparation, statistical data analysis and interpretation, Mentoring Students, Research collaboration in international environments, Grant proposal preparation

Software: Stata, R, QGIS, SPSS, EViews, LaTeX

Honors & Scholarships

- MEXT Scholarship (Doctoral), Government of Japan
- MEXT Scholarship (Master's), Government of Japan
- Allama Iqbal Scholarship (Bachelor's), Government of Pakistan

Academic Conference Presentations

International Conference Presentations

1. *The Interaction Effects of Labor Market Rigidity and Volatility of Unpredictable Exchange Rates on Exports: Analysis Based on Country–Industry Panel Data*, Econometric Society East and Southeast Asia Meeting, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam, 2024
 - *The Interaction Effects of Labor Market Firing Rigidity and Exchange Rate Volatility on Exports: Analysis Based on Country–Industry Panel Data*, Canadian Economics Association Annual Meeting (58th), Toronto Metropolitan University, Canada, 2024

Poster Presentations

1. *The Interaction Effects of Exchange Rate Volatility and Labor Market Rigidity on Export Growth: A Country–Industry Level Analysis*, Japanese Economic Association Meeting, Keizai University, Tokyo, Japan, 2024
 - *Exchange Rate Volatility and Productivity: A Country–Industry Level Analysis of Developing Countries*, Japanese Economic Association Meeting, Nanzan University, Nagoya, Japan, 2023

Invited Presentations

1. *Are the Benefits of Increasing Exports Equal? Evidence from Night Lights Data and Exogenous Export Variations*, Institute of Developing Economies (IDE-JETRO), Japan, 2025
2. *Exports, Trade Hubs, and Urban–Rural Inequality: Global Evidence from Nighttime Luminosity*, J-TREE Seminar Series, Japan, 2025
3. *Trade Hubs and the Uneven Gains from Globalization: Global Evidence from Satellite Nighttime Lights Data*, University of Tsukuba, Japan, 2024

Languages

Pashto (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Basic), Hindi/Urdu (Intermediate)

References

1. Hisahiro Naito (Main Supervisor), Director and Professor, Program in Economics and Public Policy (PEPP), University of Tsukuba
Cell Phone: +81 (29) 853-7431
Email address: naito@dppe.tsukuba.ac.jp
2. Zhengfei Yu, Associate Professor, Program in Economics and Public Policy (PEPP), University of Tsukuba
Email address: yu.zhengfei.gn@u.tsukuba.ac.jp
Cell Phone: +81 (29) 853-4075
3. Yoshinori Kurokawa, Associate Professor, Faculty of Economics, Gakushuin University, Tokyo
Cell Phone: +81-3-5992-1568
Email address: yoshinori.kurokawa@gakushuin.ac.jp

4. Kenichi Kashiwagi, Professor, Program in Economics and Public Policy (PEPP), University of Tsukuba
Email address: kashiwagi.kenichi.fn@u.tsukuba.ac.jp